gemstone-py Type-Safe Smalltalk Codegen

Generating typed wrappers from Protocol classes

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Type-Safe Smalltalk Codegen

`gemstone-codegen` turns registered Python `Protocol` classes into concrete `TypedOop` wrappers. The generated files are ordinary Python modules, so IDEs can autocomplete methods and your application code no longer has to spell the same Smalltalk strings at every call site.

Install

The generator ships with `gemstone-py`:

```
python -m pip install gemstone-py
gemstone-codegen --help
```

For source checkouts:

```
python -m pip install -e ".[examples,dev]"
python -m gemstone_py.codegen --help
```

Define Protocols

Create a module with one or more `@gemstone_class(...)` protocols:

```
from typing import Protocol
from gemstone_py import gemstone_class, gemstone_selector

@gemstone_class("OkzBooking", async_=True)
class OkzBookingProto(Protocol):
    status: str

    @classmethod
    @gemstone_selector("findById:")
    def find_by_id(cls, booking_id: str) -> "OkzBookingProto":
        ...

    def mark_paid(self, at_posix_seconds: int) -> None:
        ...

    def yourself(self) -> "OkzBookingProto":
        ...

    def customer(self) -> "OkzCustomerProto":
        ...
```

```
    @gemstone_selector("transferTo:byUserId:")
    def transfer(self, user_id: int, by_user_id: int) -> None:
        ...

@gemstone_class("OkzCustomer", async_=True)
class OkzCustomerProto(Protocol):
    name: str
```

`async_=True` asks the generator to emit both sync and async wrappers.

Generate Wrappers

Run the generator from the repository or application root:

```
gemstone-codegen \
  --module examples.typed_access.codegen_demo.models \
  --output examples/typed_access/codegen_demo/generated \
  --clean
```

The output is meant to be checked in. That keeps reviews, editor indexing, and type checking predictable:

```
git add examples/typed_access/codegen_demo/generated
```

The generated package includes `py.typed` so type checkers treat the checked-in wrapper package as typed. `--clean` removes stale generated wrapper modules when a Protocol is renamed or deleted.

Use package generation for protocols that return other generated protocols. Single-class `generate_wrapper(...)` only has enough context to resolve self-typed returns.

Use `--check` in CI or pre-commit hooks to catch drift:

```
gemstone-codegen \
  --module examples.typed_access.codegen_demo.models \
  --output examples/typed_access/codegen_demo/generated \
  --check
```

The repository CI runs the same check through:

```
./scripts/check_codegen.sh
```

If your application uses `pre-commit`, it can consume the packaged hook:

```
repos:
  - repo: https://github.com/unicompute/gemstone-py
    rev: main
    hooks:
      - id: gemstone-codegen-check
```

Selector Mapping

Default mapping is intentionally small:

Python shape	Generated Smalltalk selector
`status`	`status`
`find_by_id(id)`	`findById:`
`mark_paid(at)`	`markPaid:`
`transfer_to(user_id, by_user_id)`	`transferTo:byUserId:`

For selectors that do not map cleanly, use `@gemstone_selector(...)`. The explicit selector must have the same keyword count as the Python method has arguments.

Return Mapping

The generator uses simple Protocol annotations to choose the send path and the generated Python return type:

Protocol return annotation	Generated behaviour
no annotation	`perform_value(...)` / `session.eval(...)`, returns `Any`
`None`	sends the message and returns `None`
same Protocol class, wrapper class, or `Self`	uses `perform_oop(...)` or `execute_oop(...)` and wraps the returned OOP
another generated Protocol in the same module	uses `perform_oop(...)` or `execute_oop(...)` and lazily imports the target wrapper
simple builtins such as `str`, `int`, `float`, `bool`	value send with that return annotation

That means this method returns another typed wrapper:

```
def yourself(self) -> "OkzBookingProto":
    ...
```

and this method returns a generated `OkzCustomer` or `AsyncOkzCustomer` wrapper:

```
def customer(self) -> "OkzCustomerProto":
    ...
```

while this method is treated as a mutating command:

```
def mark_paid(self, at_posix_seconds: int) -> None:
    ...
```

Sync Usage

Generated class-side methods take a session and build the Smalltalk source:

```
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig, GemStoneSession
from examples.typed_access.codegen_demo.generated import OkzBooking

with GemStoneSession(config=GemStoneConfig.from_env()) as session:
    booking = OkzBooking.find_by_id(session, "B-1001")
    print(booking.status)
    booking.mark_paid(1_779_912_000)
    same_booking = booking.yourself()
    customer = booking.customer()
    print(customer.name)
```

That class-side call evaluates:

```
OkzBooking findById: 'B-1001'
```

Instance methods call `perform_value(...)` for value returns and `perform_oop(...)` for self-typed wrapper returns through the session associated with the returned `TypedOop`.

Async Usage

When the Protocol is registered with `async_=True`, the generator also emits an `Async...` wrapper:

```
from fastapi import Depends, FastAPI
from gemstone_py import GemStoneConfig
from gemstone_py.aio import AsyncSession
from gemstone_py.aio.fastapi import session_dependency
from examples.typed_access.codegen_demo.generated import AsyncOkzBooking

app = FastAPI()
get_gemstone =
session_dependency(config=GemStoneConfig.from_env(require_credentials=False))

@app.get("/bookings/{booking_id}")
async def booking_status(
    booking_id: str,
    session: AsyncSession = Depends(get_gemstone),
) -> dict[str, str]:
    booking = await AsyncOkzBooking.find_by_id(session, booking_id)
    return {"status": str(await booking.status())}
```

Current Scope

The first generator pass handles:

- annotated fields and `@property` methods as no-argument sends
- instance methods as `perform_value(...)` or `perform_oop(...)` sends based on return annotations
- class methods as class-side Smalltalk source strings
- self-returning class and instance methods as wrapped `TypedOop` results
- same-module cross-Protocol returns as lazily imported generated wrappers
- string, integer, float, boolean, and `None` literals in class-side calls
- explicit selector overrides with `@gemstone_selector(...)`
- checked-in sync and async generated modules with `py.typed`, stale-file cleanup, and CI/pre-commit drift checks
- an opt-in live smoke test for generated wrappers against GemStone `Date`

It does not marshal arbitrary Python objects into class-side source literals or replace hand-written Smalltalk for complex queries. Use it for method-shaped object access and keep raw `session.eval(...)` or `SmalltalkBridge` calls where a full Smalltalk expression is clearer.

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